SMART NET ZERO

A WORKING GUIDE FOR FACILITIES AND ESTATES TEAMS

Building Performance Review

From Concern To Next Step

Recurring comfort complaints, a change in energy use or an equipment improvement request can bring several questions into the same discussion. What has been observed? Which service is affected? What does the available information establish? What should further investigation answer?

Use this guide to prepare a focused review of one concern. The worksheet brings the issue, evidence and open questions together so your team can agree a useful next step.

How To Use This Guide

Building-performance concerns often involve several contributing factors. HSE guidance on thermal comfort, for example, considers environmental and personal factors alongside air temperature. Recording where and when a concern occurs gives the review a clearer starting point.

The information available also needs context. CIBSE's TM39 metering guidance addresses measurement boundaries and the use of metered data. For this review, establish which area and period a record covers and how it relates to the question before drawing conclusions from it.

The three stages below help you bring that context together: define the concern, understand what the available information establishes and agree the next question to take forward.

01

Define The Concern

Describe the issue, where and when it occurs, and the decision it needs to inform.

02

Understand The Available Position

Bring together relevant records and identify what they establish and what remains open.

03

Agree The Next Step

Agree the next question, who will take it forward and how the findings will be used.

Start with a decision you need to make. Complete the worksheet with the colleagues or service providers who hold relevant information, using records you already have where they are suitable.

Record the source of an observation and distinguish it from a possible explanation. Where something remains uncertain, note what needs checking and who can help. You do not need every field completed before the discussion can move forward.

01 Define The Concern

Describe one issue precisely enough for others to understand what needs reviewing. A report of discomfort, for example, identifies an experience worth examining; it does not establish an equipment fault.

Building, area or service

Concern being reviewed

Where and when it occurs

Source of the observation or report

People, activities or services affected

Relevant operating circumstances or recent changes

Decision this review needs to inform

Keep the observation and its possible explanation separate. “The meeting room feels uncomfortable during afternoon bookings” describes the concern. “The cooling equipment needs replacing” is a proposed response that needs supporting evidence.

02 Understand The Available Position

Select information that relates to the question. Depending on the issue, this could include operating arrangements, booking records, maintenance reports, available readings, drawings or information held by a service provider.

Information Or Record 1

Record 1: Information or record

Record 1: Source / responsible contributor

Record 1: Area and period covered

Record 1: What it helps establish

Record 1: Gap or check needed

Information Or Record 2

Record 2: Information or record

Record 2: Source / responsible contributor

Record 2: Area and period covered

Record 2: What it helps establish

Record 2: Gap or check needed

For a performance record, establish what it covers and the period it represents before deciding how to use it.

02 Understand The Available Position

Select information that relates to the question. Depending on the issue, this could include operating arrangements, booking records, maintenance reports, available readings, drawings or information held by a service provider.

Information Or Record 3

Record 3: Information or record

Record 3: Source / responsible contributor

Record 3: Area and period covered

Record 3: What it helps establish

Record 3: Gap or check needed

Information Or Record 4

Record 4: Information or record

Record 4: Source / responsible contributor

Record 4: Area and period covered

Record 4: What it helps establish

Record 4: Gap or check needed

For a performance record, establish what it covers and the period it represents before deciding how to use it.

02 Consider Relevant Dependencies

What else does the affected asset or service rely on? Relevant questions may concern controls, communications, shared plant or supplier support. Select what matters to the concern rather than trying to map the whole building.

For systems that monitor or control physical equipment, consider the connections they need to function and the assets that depend on them.

Dependency 1

Dependency 1: Relevant asset, system or dependency

Dependency 1: Why it matters to this question

Dependency 1: Who can clarify it?

Dependency 2

Dependency 2: Relevant asset, system or dependency

Dependency 2: Why it matters to this question

Dependency 2: Who can clarify it?

03 Agree The Next Step

Use the review to identify what the available information supports and which unanswered question matters to the decision. The next step might be to clarify a record, obtain an observation from the responsible team or commission an appropriately scoped assessment.

What the available evidence supports

What remains uncertain

Question further review needs to answer

Why the answer matters to the service or decision

Information or assessment needed

Responsible person or team

Other contributors required

Decision the findings will inform

Agreed review date or trigger

Keep The Review Useful

Before commissioning further work, make its purpose explicit. Explain what is already known, what remains open and how the findings will be used. This gives the relevant team or specialist a clearer basis for proposing the scope.

Before closing the discussion, check that:

- The concern and the decision required are clear.
- Important observations can be traced to their source.
- Possible explanations remain distinguishable from established facts.
- The next step has an owner and an agreed review point.
- The people carrying out further work understand what their findings need to inform.

Return to the record when new information becomes available or the situation changes. Update the evidence and next question so the review remains useful to the people making the decision.

About This Guide

Prepared by Smart Net Zero for facilities and estates teams. The worksheet is our practical organising aid, informed by the guidance linked above.

SMART NET ZERO

YOUR NEXT BUILDING-PERFORMANCE DECISION

Give Your Next Decision A Clearer Starting Point

Has your review identified a question your team needs help taking forward? Bring it to Smart Net Zero.

Through SmartDiscovery360, we bring your objective, assets, systems and available information into context, helping establish what is known, where the gaps are and what needs further review within the agreed scope.

Discuss Your Building Performance Review

Send us your worksheet or a short summary of the concern and the decision it needs to support.

info@smartnetzero.co.uk →

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